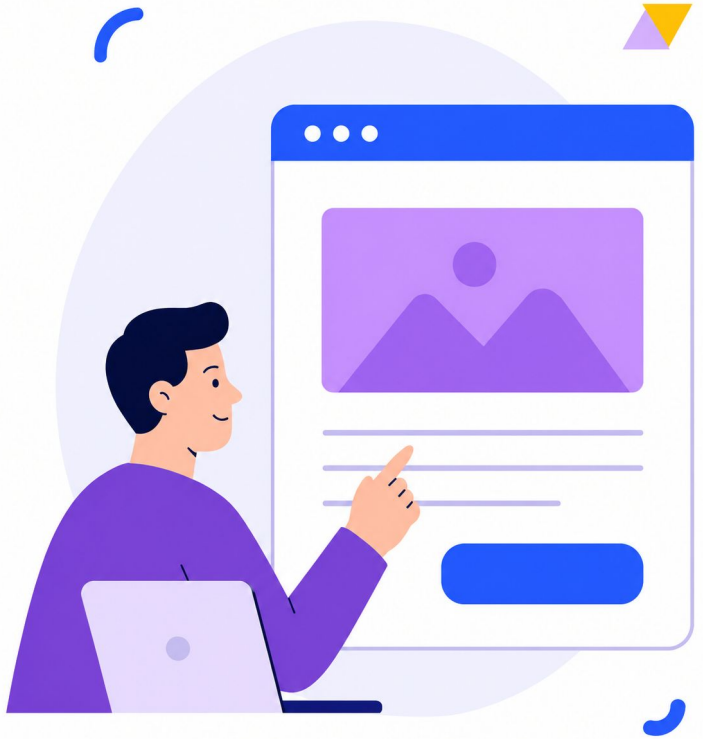
Digital Marketing Strategy - Bonus

M2 - Inalco



Perfect Ad Formula



Ad Success



Strategy

- Define clear objectives (e.g. awareness, leads, sales).
- Understand your audience and their needs.
- Choose the right channels and offer.
- Set realistic goals and KPIs.

×



Creative

- Grab attention in the first seconds.
- Tell a compelling story.
- Show value and proof (e.g. testimonials, results).
- Keep the message simple and focused.
- Include a clear call to action.

×



Targeting

- Reach the right audience (at the right time).
- Use data and segmentation (demographics, interests, behavior).
- Test and refine audiences.
- Exclude irrelevant audiences.
- Personalize the message when possible.

×



Measurement

- Track key metrics (CTR, CVR, ROAS, CPA...).
- Analyze performance and learn from data.
- Run A/B tests.
- Optimize continuously (scale what works, improve what doesn't).
- Measure both short-term and long-term impact (e.g. brand lift, LTV).

What Makes a Perfect Ad

Hook • **Emotion** • **Proof** • **Native Format** • **CTA**

Definition

A perfect ad is not just visually attractive. It is an ad that:

- captures **attention** quickly,
- communicates **one clear promise**,
- supports that promise with **credible proof**,
- moves the **right audience** toward one specific **action**.

In Practice

In practical terms, the best-performing ads usually:

- **communicate the core value very early**, often within the first seconds
- **align the message**, **visual format**, and **audience expectation** instead of trying to say everything at once.

Ad Structure



Hook

First 3 seconds

- Capture attention
- Use a bold visual, question, pain point or unexpected statement

Hook Rate =
(3-second views ÷ impressions) × 100

Good benchmark: > 35%

×



Body

Middle section

- Deliver value
- Show proof or storytelling
- Keep a fast pace

Hold Rate =
(video completions or 50% views + 3-second views)

Higher is better

×



CTA

Last 3–5 seconds

- Drive one clear action
- Make it simple and specific (e.g. Shop now, Sign up)
- Reinforce the benefit

Measured by CTR, conversion rate and CPA

What Makes a Perfect Ad

Hook

The hook is the opening moment of the ad. Its role is to stop the scroll, interrupt the normal viewing pattern, and create immediate curiosity, tension, recognition, or relevance. A strong hook can be a bold visual, a surprising claim, a direct question, or a pain point the audience instantly recognizes.

Emotion

Emotion is one of the strongest drivers of ad performance because people do not respond only to information; they respond to feelings, identity, relief, hope, fear, belonging, trust, and aspiration.

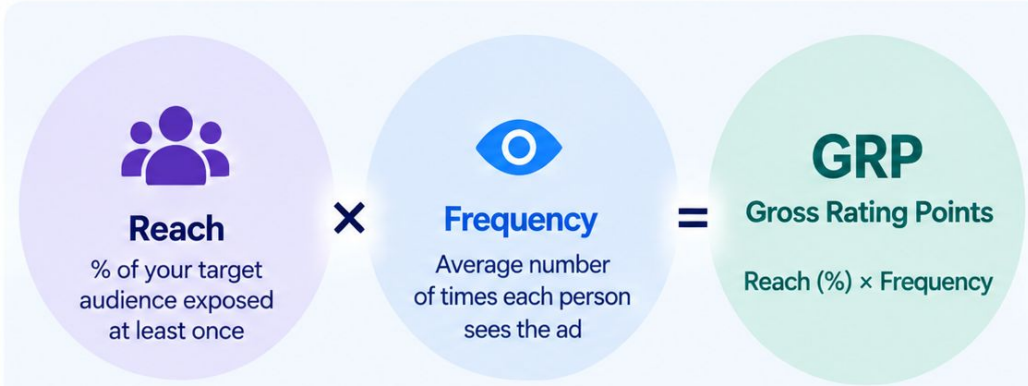
Proof

Proof is what makes the ad believable. It can take the form of reviews, demonstrations, testimonials, screenshots, product outcomes, visible transformations, ratings, or statistics. The function of proof is to reduce doubt and help the audience trust that the offer is real and useful.

CTA

CTA means call to action. A strong CTA asks for one action only, such as “Buy now,” “Book a call,” “Start free,” or “Download the guide.” The more specific and direct the CTA is, the easier it is for the audience to know what to do next.

Ad Metrics



Reach % = (Unique users reached ÷ Total target audience) × 100

Frequency = Total impressions ÷ Unique reach

GRP = Reach (%) × Frequency

Impressions = Reach × Frequency

Key benchmarks

3–7 exposures

are often needed for an ad to be memorable and persuasive.

Why it matters

- Measure total exposure
- Plan media budgets
- Compare campaigns
- Understand audience saturation

High-Performing Ad Elements

One message

A strong ad focuses on one main benefit or one main problem. If the ad tries to communicate too many ideas at once, the audience remembers less and the message becomes weaker.

Native creative

The creative should feel natural within the platform where it appears. On TikTok, Instagram Reels, and many Meta placements, ads often perform better when they resemble creator content, user-generated content, short demos, reactions, or story-led content instead of overly polished commercials.

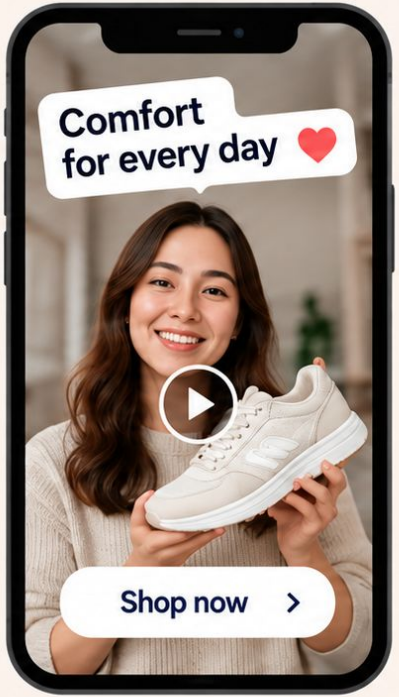
Message match

The ad and the landing page must match. If the ad promises a clear benefit, the landing page should continue the same promise, show the same proof, and make the next step easy. A disconnect between ad and landing page usually lowers conversion performance.

Testing discipline

Strong advertisers test creative systematically. They often vary one element at a time, such as the hook, the format, the CTA, or the proof style, so they can understand which change actually improved results.

Perfect Ad Recap



1. **Stops the scroll in 3 seconds**
   Use a bold visual, question or unexpected statement.
2. **Makes people feel something**
   Emotional ads are ~2x more profitable than rational ones.
3. **Feels native, not like an ad**
   Use UGC, tutorials or real stories.
4. **Focuses on one clear benefit**
   Keep the message simple and specific.
5. **Includes verifiable proof**
   Show reviews, results, demos or testimonials.
6. **Mixes emotional + rational copy**
   Combine feelings with facts.
7. **Has a single, clear CTA**
   One action only (e.g. Shop now).
8. **Uses consistent brand assets**
   Colors, logo, characters, style.
9. **Optimized for platform & format**
   Vertical, mobile-first, sound-off, fast pacing.
10. **Tested systematically**
    Try multiple variants (e.g. 3 × 3 × 3 = 27).

Perfect Ad Quick Checklist

Use this before launching an ad

- Hook is clear in the first 1–3 seconds.
- One main benefit is obvious immediately.
- The ad speaks to a specific audience problem or desire.
- The creative feels native to the platform.
- The message is understandable in under 2 seconds.
- The ad includes proof: demo, review, testimonial, result, screenshot, or rating.
- The emotional angle is clear: urgency, relief, aspiration, curiosity, humor, or trust.
- The CTA asks for one action only.
- The landing page matches the promise in the ad.
- Text is readable on mobile and works sound-off.
- Brand assets are recognizable but do not overpower the message.
- At least 3–5 variations are ready for testing.

Simple scoring grid

Score each item from 0 to 2:

0 = missing
1 = partially there
2 = strong

Interpretation

- **20–24:** strong ad foundation
- **14–19:** workable but needs improvement
- **0–13:** weak ad, revise before launch

Case Study – Columbia (Expedition Impossible)



The idea

Columbia challenged people to **"prove the Earth is flat and win the company"**, turning a well-known conspiracy theory into a participatory brand stunt.

The result

Won the **2026 Cannes Lions Grand Prix** for Brand Experience and Activation.

Audience reaction

Wass participation across social media: videos, debates, memes and discussions amplified the campaign worldwide.

Why it worked

- **Simple and provocative**
  A premise anyone could understand and debate.
- **Turned viewers into participants**
  Every reaction, video, and argument became free distribution.
- **Aligned with the brand**
  Tightly connected to Columbia's identity as an outdoor exploration brand.

Brand fit

Reinforced Columbia's positioning as a brand for explorers, encouraging curiosity, adventure and evidence-based exploration.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=N0WxAUkBuQA

Case Study – Spotify (Wrapped)



The idea

Spotify turns annual listener data into a global celebration, giving users **personalized "Wrapped" stories** they want to share.

The result

Consistently cited as one of the **most effective annual campaigns**; in 2025 it drove massive earned media and cultural conversation.

Audience reaction

Millions of users shared their Wrapped graphics, sparking global conversations, memes and media coverage every year.

Why it worked

- **Made users the content**
  People voluntarily posted their Wrapped graphics across social media.
- **Combined identity, nostalgia and social proof**
  A highly shareable format that taps into personal identity and emotions.
- **Scaled globally**
  With local fan destinations and artist-specific installations.

Brand fit

Perfectly aligned with Spotify's mission to bring people closer through music, turning data into a meaningful and cultural moment.

Case Study – Squarespace (Domain Names)



The idea

Squarespace hired Emma Stone and director Yorgos Lanthimos to turn **domain names** into a **cinematic noir story** for the Super Bowl.

The result

Highly praised Super Bowl spot in 2026, generating **massive earned media**, conversation and brand relevance for Squarespace.

Audience reaction

Sparked widespread discussion across social media, press and the creative industry, with praise for its originality, direction and star power.

Why it worked

- **Entertainment-first approach**
  A cinematic, high-craft film that captured attention while keeping the product (domain names) at the center of the plot.
- **Proved B2B can be entertaining**
  Showed how software brands can use Hollywood-level storytelling without losing product clarity.

Brand fit

Reinforced Squarespace's position as a creative, modern platform that empowers individuals and businesses to bring their ideas to life online.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2cLNMXUNzxY

Case Study – Adidas (Supernova Adaptive)



The idea

adidas created the Supernova Rise 3 Adaptive, its **first performance running shoe designed in partnership with athletes with disabilities**, based on real accessibility needs.

The result

Launched globally on World Down Syndrome Day 2026; won the **2026 Cannes Lions Innovation Grand Prix.**

Why it worked

- **Innovation is in the product**
  Accessibility built into the design, not just a purpose message.
- **Designed with the community**
  Co-created with athletes with disabilities to meet real needs.
- **Real benefits, real users**
  Showed real people and real performance in everyday life.

What makes it credible

Multi-year collaboration with athletes and experts, including focus groups, extensive testing and feedback. Recognized with the **GAMUT Seal of Approval.**

https://www.instagram.com/reels/DWJbnXlAJnh/
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ETf0OoDe7N8